

THE “EVIL GLOBALIZATION” AND THE CENTRAL DIALECTIC TUG-OF-WAR IN THE NEW GLOBALIZATION’S SHAPING

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Abstract: Over the recent years there has been internationally a tremendous increase in the number of people engaged in the very concept of globalization and the economic crisis. This largely prolongs a lot of infertile conflict between some opposing “entrenched camps”, in scientific as well as social and political terms. Unfortunately, this process of thought takes a character, most often, extreme, dogmatic, and aphoristic. This article is structured in a way to:

- First, unravel the threads of globalization dynamics, of their development and crisis, and to establish a basic analytical framework towards the search for a “new globalization”.
- Second, investigate the structural socio-economic opposing views of global dynamics (the tug of war between the critical dimensions of Globalization) that advance always in an evolutionary way.
- Third, based on the available data, evaluate the most significant accomplishments, of every area of interest, which derive from the Globalization evolutionary procedure.
- In the end, rewrite the main directions that a modern socio-economic global intervention requires in terms of moving the world system towards a new phase of development, which we call the “New Globalization”.

Key-words: Globalization, world system, dynamics of globalization, global development and crisis.

1. Introduction and conceptual prerequisites

It is, to say the least, obvious that most of the ongoing dialogue with respect to globalization ends up in a dogmatic (for or against) way to perceive its content and the desired prospects (Abélès, 2008; Adda, 2012; Cohen E., 2001; Cohen S., 2003; Corm, 2010; Graz, 2013; Gruzinski, 2006; Huntington S. P., 2005; Montel-Dumont, 2011; Montel-Dumont, 2007; Mucchielli, 1998; Norel, 2013; Sassen, 2009; Stiglitz, 2003). And, of course, this dogmatic confrontation, as always, it depletes the essence of the problem, because it tends to prevail so easily and as a result to build some ideological fortresses, of great strength, inside the nations, that it can no longer be rejected or bypassed.

Moving, inevitably, in greater analytical depths, contemporary international policies, all along the political spectrum, are radically redefined, divided and be again added, decomposed and be afterwards composed, under the view of this necessary phase of globalization restructuring and crisis. It is by no means an accident that in several parts of the world two “right-wing” and two “left-wing” political thoughts are “suddenly” emerging: Two “left-wing” and two “right-wing” approaches that welcome the goods of globalization and a respective opposing pair which sees in globalization something that is definitely against the progress of humanity (Gerbé & Ghebali, 1996; Ghorra-Gobin, 2012; Sallman, 2011; Sapir, 2011).

In the center of this new international controversy, new several socio-political questions arise:

- Which is finally the “progressive” and which the “conservative” policy inside globalization?
- Who are those who betray their “ideological tradition” and who really support the dynamics of capitalism?
- And even more importantly: Where can be found the new focal points of agreement and disagreement, and in the midst of what, exactly, political positions place themselves in the context of globalization?

A valid and realistic approach to answer all these questions requires, first, to clarify the real content and the dynamics of globalization themselves.

1.1 The mixed nature of the globalization dynamics

In fact, globalization is neither (and never was) something totally “white” nor totally “black”, in any of its dimensions. It is neither a “paradise” nor a “hell”, it is something neither static, nor finished, nor done. Globalization is and has always been an “open game” in an evolutionary process.

Globalization is, in particular, the process of a structural integration and incorporation of its various functional components on a global scale, resulting from the circulation of products, services, capital, entrepreneurship, ideas, symbols, mechanisms and of any other element that flows in, transforms and flows out, respectively, from and to any of the underlying socio-economic systems and organizations. The dynamics of globalization are, therefore, a continuous flow of developments and structural transformations that span on a global scale and change the very nature and function of the individual agents of action of which globalization is made up. And there is no doubt that some internal changes are for the better, while some other for the worse, by respectively increasing or decreasing the inherent capacity for survival and development of globalization’s parts.

Therefore, to blame easily globalization is a complete disorientation. What humanity needs today is to open up with realism, and traverse as safely as possible, the paths of improvement and, at the same time, to avoid the trajectory of failure. In this sense, to evaluate as accurately and with clarity as possible the modern world dynamics is of critical importance. So that we may, in the midst of the justified criticism on globalization’s weaknesses, obstruct the progress of sterile negativity and intolerance against different social groups.

1.2 The crisis of globalization and the “New Globalization”.

The subject matter named after the crisis of globalization (Abraham-Fois, 2001; Aglietta, 1997; Bianchi, Delbeke, & Vasko, 1985; Bowles, Gordon, & Weisskopf, 1986; Boyer, 1986; Chevalier & Pastré, 2002; Dockès (dir), 2002; Freeman, 1986; Lorenzi, Pastre, & Toledano, 1984); Rosier & Dockes, 1983; Mandel, 1995; Rossier, 1975; Schumpeter, 1937) it has literally upset every certainty, at all levels, both domestically and internationally. Nothing, at all levels, is continuously secured, nothing is by definition certain: Regarding businesses, economic activity, domestic policies, social and personal prosperity.

Every particular phenomenon, the several financial shocks, the urgent bail-outs, and the relatively restored rate of GDP growth of several countries after the 2008 events, down to the still high unemployment rates across various socio-economic systems, all these facts show the struggle for a “New Globalization” to be born out of the crisis (Aglietta, 1998; Artus & Virard, 2015; Boltansky & Chiapello, 1999; Boyer, 2002; Braudel, 2014; Brender & Pisani, 2009; Chavagneux, 2011; Curien, 2005; Dardot & Laval, 2010; Dobbs, Lund, Woetzel, & Mu-

tafchieva, 2015; Gordon, 2016; Reich, 1993; Rifkin, 2002): to emerge and shape by a significantly painful “birth”, by having a fairly vague future framework, and inside vast socio-economic and political turbulences and disturbances that are already articulated on a global scale.

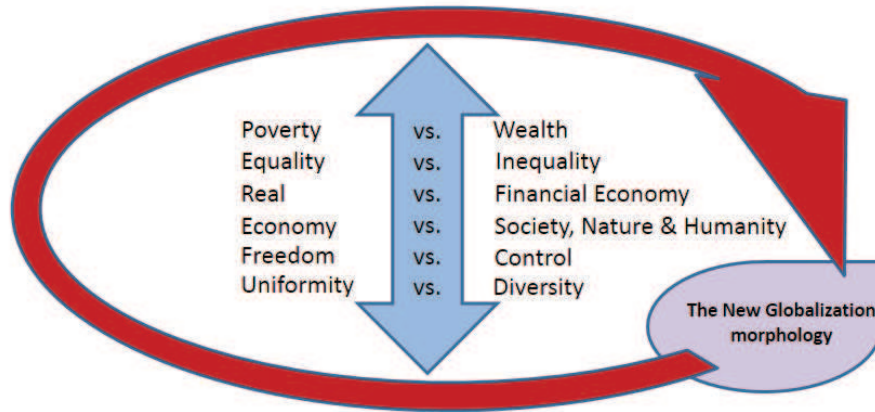
The global crisis we experience these days is the offspring of a long structural maturity process which was incubated for the last thirty years inside globalization. Like in every phase of the global evolution of capitalism (Michalet, 1998; Saint-Onge, 2000; Salmon, 2000; Veltz, 2008), the current crisis came as a structural de-stabilization of the old development model, on a global scale, which was manifested over the last years, since 2008. It became obvious when an extensive chain of events started, when the subprime mortgage market collapses and spreads all over the world, over every socio-economic system. And, certainly, that crisis hadn’t been something unexpected; on the contrary, it firmly established its footing on top of the structural maturity of the “previous development phase” of globalization (Agarwala & Singh, 1965; Amsden, 2001; Assidon, 2000; Bairoch & Asselain, 2005; Berthélémy, 1999; Krugman, 1992; North D. , 1990; Perroux, 1962; Ray, 1998): This maturity was the evolutionary result of the last three decades, from the mid-1980s and until approximately the mid-2000s.

Nowadays, for the world to surpass the crisis and restructure the global dynamics towards a new, stable development model, which we call the “New Globalization”, it requires a powerful innovative leap, at all levels. Under this innovative restructuring there lie, inevitably, the ways and methods to manage the change, namely the Change Management techniques, which would allow and make possible the transition towards this innovative overleaping (Βλάχος, 2006; Βλάχος, 2017).

2. The supposedly negative effects of Globalization and the fundamental tug of war between the forces of the New Globalization

The search for a “new globalization” is calling for an answer to the never-ending questions which concern the evolution of the global economy and society: to give some answers to those deep central dilemmas, to the global tug of war of our shared journey. (See Figure 1)

Figure 1: The morphology of the “New Globalization”



This endeavor, it seems, encompasses a non-dogmatic, calm and not influenced by strong feelings, weighted review of the globalization dynamics, as these were unfolded the past few decades on all of the socio-economic and political battlefronts in globalization.

How “bad” was the globalization over the previous phase of development? The following examination suggests that to walk in the opposite direction, by analyzing the positive impact of globalization, is a far more stable conceptual route.

2.1 Poverty vs. Wealth

Globalization has not, of course, obliterated poverty in our planet. The world is continuously bound by poverty, shortage of all kinds and by the fundamental economic problem of scarcity, from the very first moment of its existence until this day (Rosenberg & Birdzell, 1987). However, contrary to popular belief, things are heading towards the right direction, especially recently.

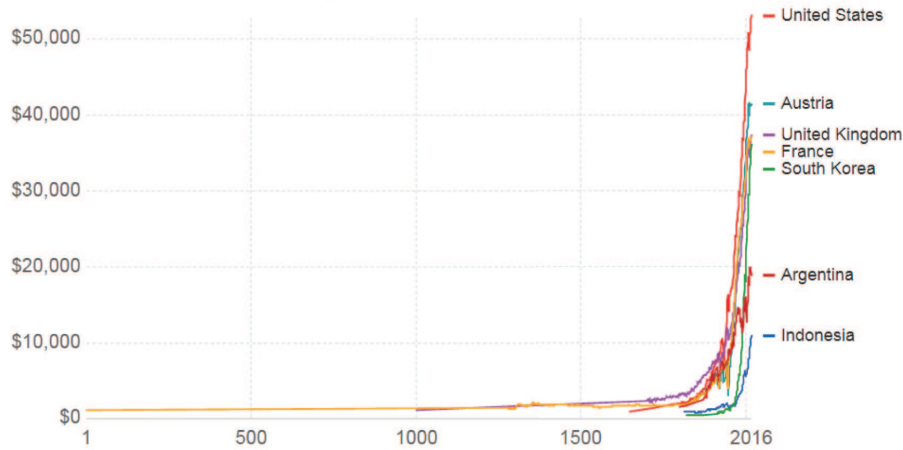
- An increasingly large number of people is considerably less poor

Statistical data reveal that poverty is not rapidly growing in the era of globalization in our planet, despite the opinion of many anti-globalists (Cohen D. , 2011). (See Figure 2)

Figure 2

GDP per capita

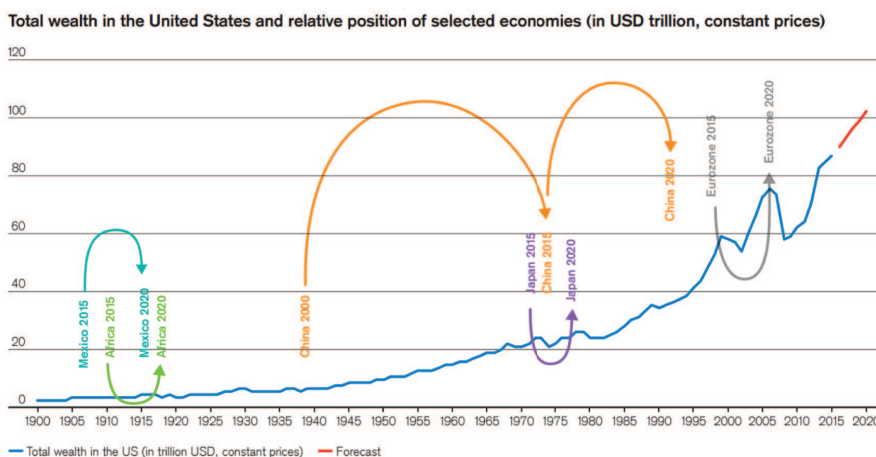
Real GDP per capita is measured using US\$, inflation adjusted at prices of 2011. A single benchmark in 2011 makes these series suitable for studying the growth of incomes over time (but not for comparing income levels between countries over time).



Data Source: *The Maddison-Project (2018)*
 Graph Source: *Roser & Ortiz-Ospina (2018)*

On the contrary, based on long-drawn statistical data, it is clear that since the beginning of the capitalistic 19th century the world enters a very rapid phase of economic growth. Furthermore, in terms of producing wealth, the 20th century –and especially after the 1950’s– shows most of the planet’s regions to take off, except for the African continent. Also, a lot of regions seem at last to succeed in drastically reducing the distance and time that separates them from the rich Northern America. (See Figure 3)

Figure 3

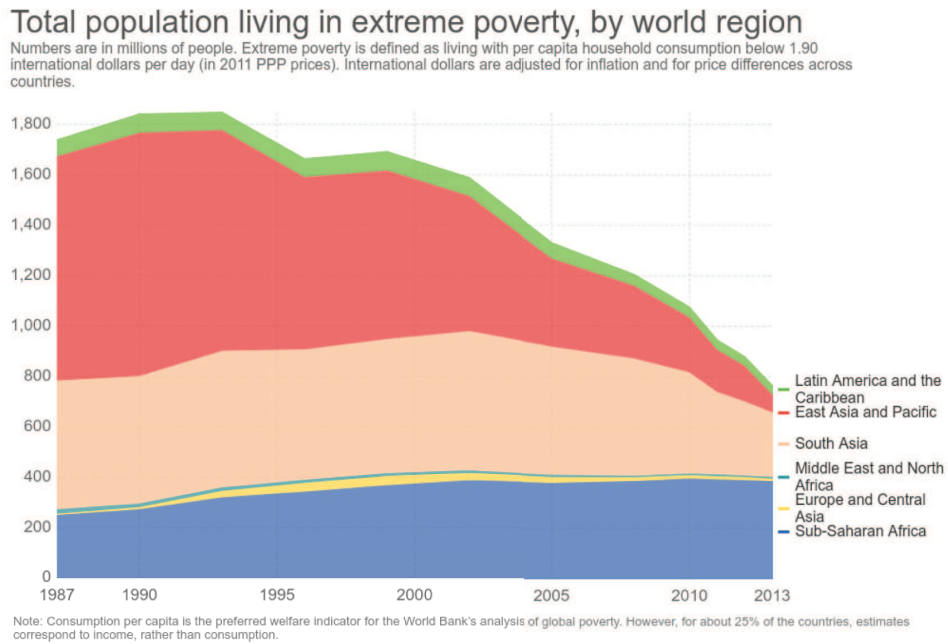


Source: *Davies, Lluberas, & Shorrocks (2016)*

► The war against extreme poverty

At the same time, evidence suggests that the fight against extreme poverty is heading recently towards some really encouraging results. (See Figure 4)

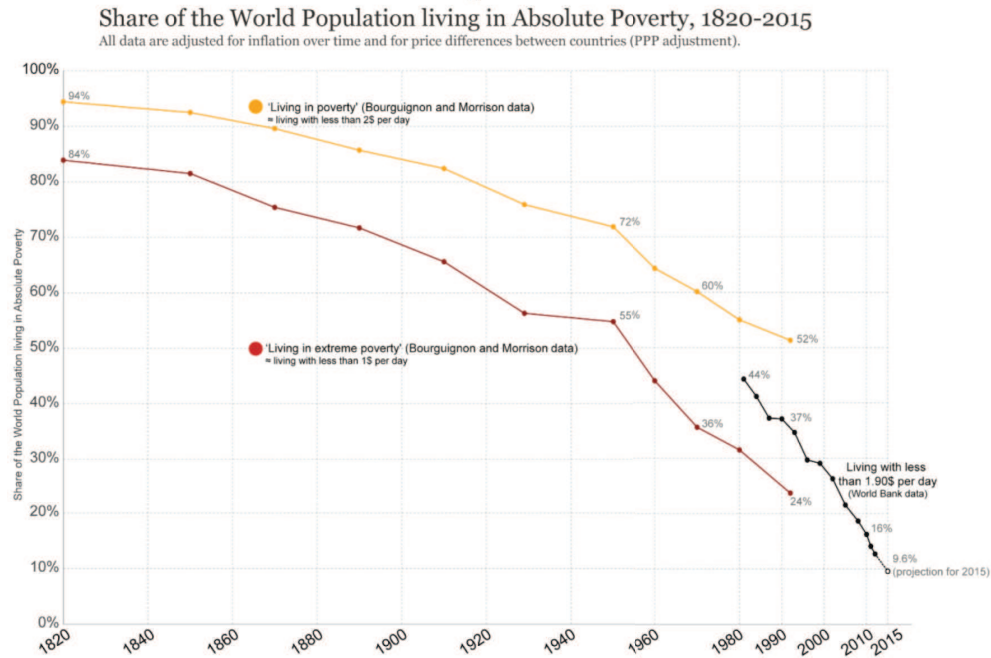
Figure 4



Source: Roser & Ortiz-Ospina (2018)

When globalization enters through its most thriving period, somewhere around 1995, the number of people living in extreme poverty it drastically decreases, a trend that is going to continue until this day despite the present crisis of globalization and the global restructuring. (See Figure 5)

Figure 6



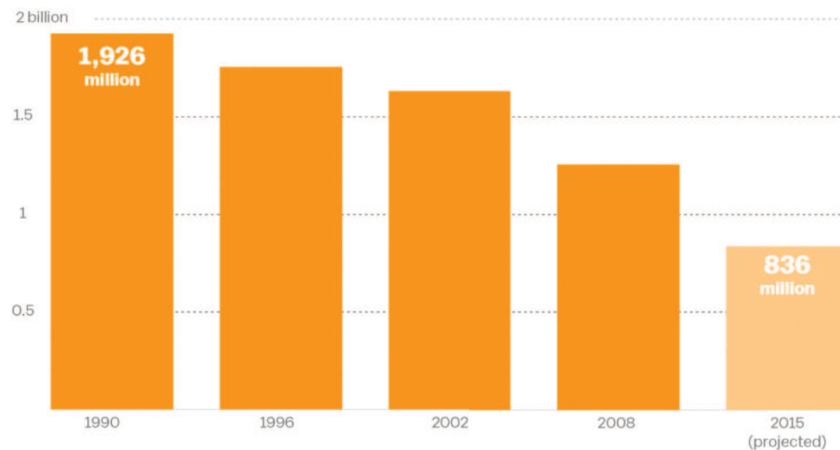
Data Source: For the 1820-1992 period, the calculations were based on Bourguignon & Morrisson (2002), and for the 1981-2015 on The World Bank (2016)
Source: Roser & Ortiz-Ospina (2018)

We may observe, over here, a fairly striking achievement of modern humanity against the old trauma caused by human poverty: To many people's surprise, the number of people living in extreme poverty worldwide has declined by more than half from 1990 to 2015, namely in just 25 years, during the time of the "accursed" development of globalization. (See Figure 7)

Figure 7

The number of people living in extreme poverty has declined by more than half

Living on less than \$1.25 a day worldwide



*Data Source: For the 1820-1992 period, the calculations were based on Bourguignon & Morrisson (2002), and for the 1981-2015 on The World Bank (2016)
Source: Roser & Ortiz-Ospina (2018)*

► What to blame, in the long run, for the perpetuation of poverty? To search not only for growth but also development.

Over the past 50 years, the national governments of less developed economies implemented, most often by the support of international organizations, several anti-poverty strategies. In the same direction, the so-called basic needs approach (Farooq, 2009; Ghai, 2009; Jolly, 1976; OECD, 2008; UNDP, 2008) strategies were introduced. Their focus was on rapidly improve the living conditions of the population (of one generations’ poor people, in particular), via rapidly increasing the production of the basic consumer goods and, in the long run, by means of economic growth. However, the historical experience shows that these policies alone cannot solve the deep problem of poverty.

Which are, finally, the underlying causes of poverty? Most of them are expressed, in the long run, in low productivity terms; yet these are interconnected and rooted to the structural causes of the several less developed socio-economic systems. And there, within this problem, lies the big challenge of the global economy in the years to come: How will the world manage to hit poverty deep

in the roots, in the structural dimensions that generate poverty, and not to simply deal with the results of it (De Soto, 2003; Rodrik, 2011)?

To simply reduce poverty in terms of conventional economic growth, it is a necessary but not sufficient condition for an unimpeded future development, especially regarding the less developed societies in our planet. To understand the essence of underdevelopment is to look beyond the narrow, strictly economic criteria, as underdevelopment stands for a mixed socio-economic evolutionary structure (Gillis, Radelet, Snodgrass, Roemer, & Perkins, 2001).

As F. Perroux clarifies (Perroux, 1964): “Economic development is the combination of moral and social changes of a population that make possible to increase, cumulatively and continuously, the real total product.” Growth is simply to increase in size and represents the inflation of some indicators. On the contrary, the idea of economic development is uninterruptedly attached to the idea of economic evolution. It requires changes in flows and structures, everything is inevitably attached to the other, in contrast to a “random” and incoherent succession within the irreversible and historical time (Perroux, 1981). Therefore, the increase in wealth and in per capita income it is not a sufficient condition for an upward spiral of economic development to be structured around the poorest societies on the planet. Deep structural changes are required in order for the less developed socio-economic systems to systematically increase their potential on the war of humanity against poverty and scarcity of resources. And, most importantly, their capacity to effectively innovate and to successfully manage the socio-economic change (Rosenberg & Birdzell, 1987).

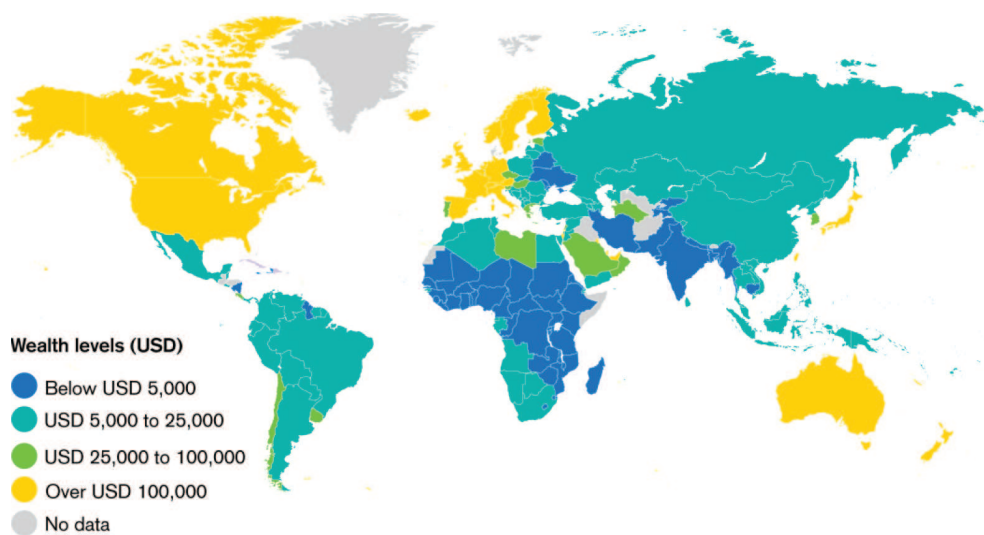
2.2 *Equality vs. Inequality*

Absolute equality does not, most definitely, characterize the world we live in. Already from the very birth of the globally integrated capitalism itself (when waged labour first appeared), at the end of the 18th century, the unequal growth of wealth and the polarization in development terms would be present and evident (Rodrik, 2011, p. 133).

► Capitalism is not a mechanism that produces equality, but what else can we do?

Overall, the capitalism dynamics, by nature, is neither –nor will there ever be– a mechanism which produces equality and, of course, modern world is not a world of equally shared wealth (See Figure 8)

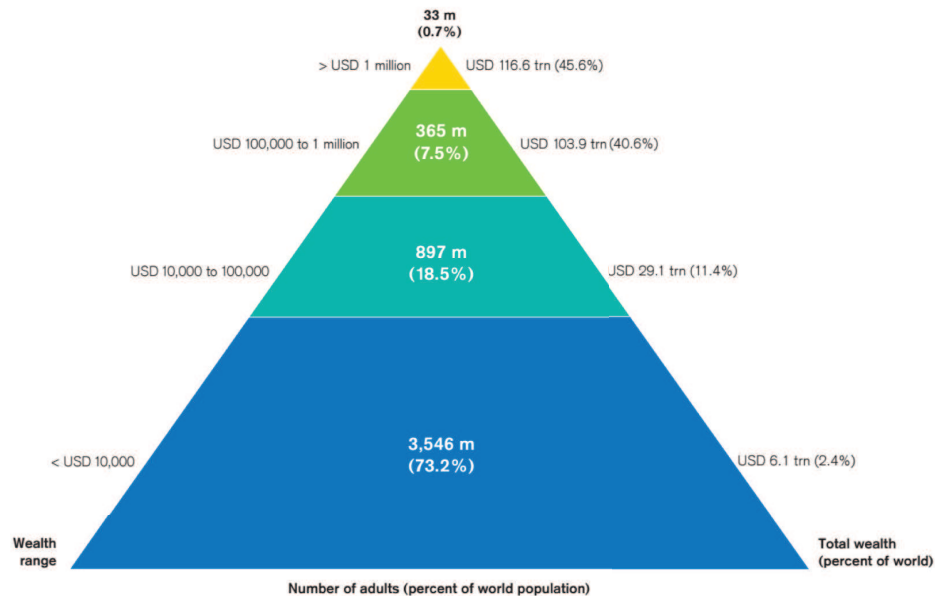
Figure 8



Source: Davies, Lluberias, & Shorrocks (2015)

The pyramid of global wealth shows that less than 1% of the world’s population owns more than the 45% of the wealth, while over 70% owns just the 3% of that wealth. (See Figure 9)

Figure 9: The global wealth pyramid



Source: Davies, Lluberias, & Shorrocks (2016)

Civitas Gentium 6:1 (2018)

While the global economy was entering into the pre-globalization phase – already from the mid-1970s – a lot of international programs and national economic development strategies started to multiply in most of the less developed countries, which they not only focus on achieving economic growth, but they also try to accomplish, primarily, the goals of equality and collective harmony, with respect to the social, economic and environmental level of analysis, within a society that is constantly developing.

These strategies proved inefficient in practice. Overall, this happens because inequality cannot be treated radically by just mere “injections” of equality. It requires profound and comprehensive changes, innovations and reforms within every socioeconomic system that is suffering.

► How much does inequality hurt inside the global system?

To this point, perhaps, there is one of the thorniest questions in the modern journey of globalization.

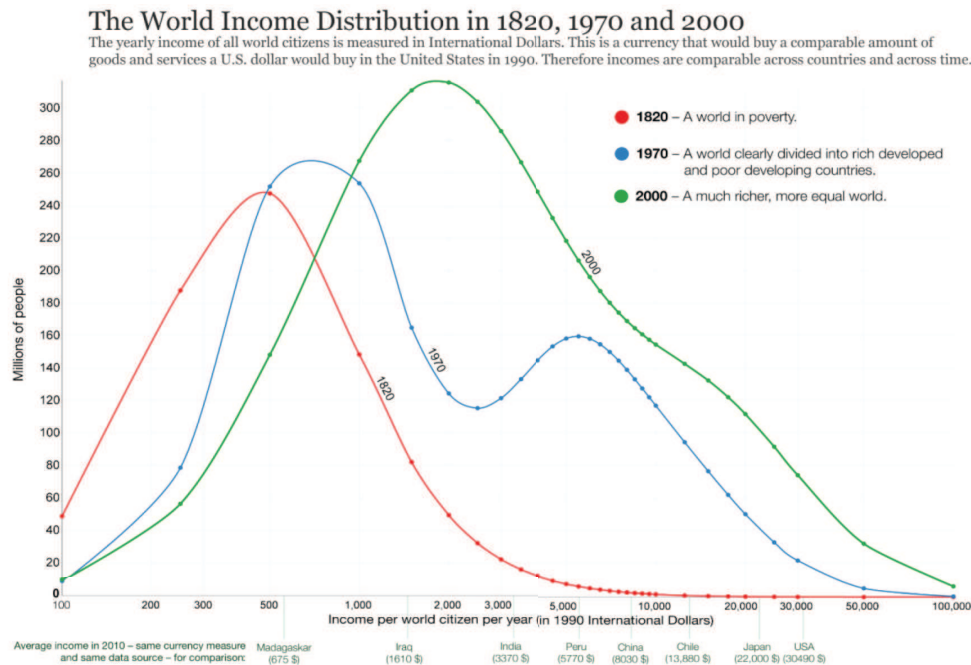
Quite recently, Jonathan Ostry and his colleagues at the IMF issued a study under the title *Redistribution, Inequality and Growth* (Ostry, Berg, & Tsangarides, 2014), which compares historical data from different countries. In this study, they specifically refer to the economic inequalities that are present on the planet and thus point out: “... inequality can undermine progress in health and education, lead to political and economic instability, and therefore reduce the investment prospects of businesses. It furthermore puts at risk the required in the face of a big shock social consensus”.

Nowadays, a large group of economists and theorists seem to be deeply concerned about the shrinking middle class and the widening of economic inequalities (Bourguignon, 2018; Dabla-Norris, Kochhar, Suphaphiphat, & Tsounta, 2015; Elliott, 2017; Fletcher, 2013; Neuman, 2014; Neves, Silva, & Afonso, 2016; Piketty, 2017; OECD, 2011; The Economist, 2014).

► How does inequality across the globe really evolve?

It seems sure that it is far better to be poor in a rich country than rich in a poor country (Rodrik, 2011, p. 131). Although, a calm observation to the long-term statistics, with respect to reducing the global inequality, and under certain conditions, might leave enough space for optimism. (See Figure 10)

Figure 10



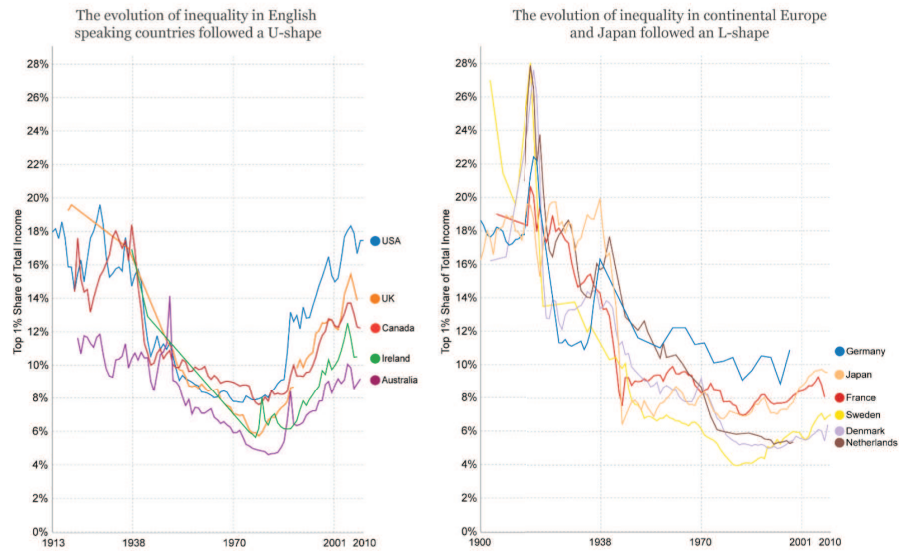
Data Source: van Zanden & et al. (eds) (2014)

Source: Roser & Ortiz-Ospina (2018)

In fact, at the beginning of the nineteenth century, at the starting point of capitalism, the planet was really poor, while the inequality, of course, was much less, but much more painful. One hundred and fifty years later, the world was already deeply divided into the rich and poor, but on an absolute basis it was on a better level than the previous, even for the poor. These days, everything seems a lot better, heading towards a planet far richer with less inequality, overall. Apart from this, the long-term statistics reveal that the portion of the income, which is directed to the rich 1%, from 1900 to 2010, to the Continental Europe and Japan, it is drastically reducing, since the beginning of the twentieth century until the 80’s, and it does not drastically increase after 1980, in most cases. (See Figure 11)

Figure 11

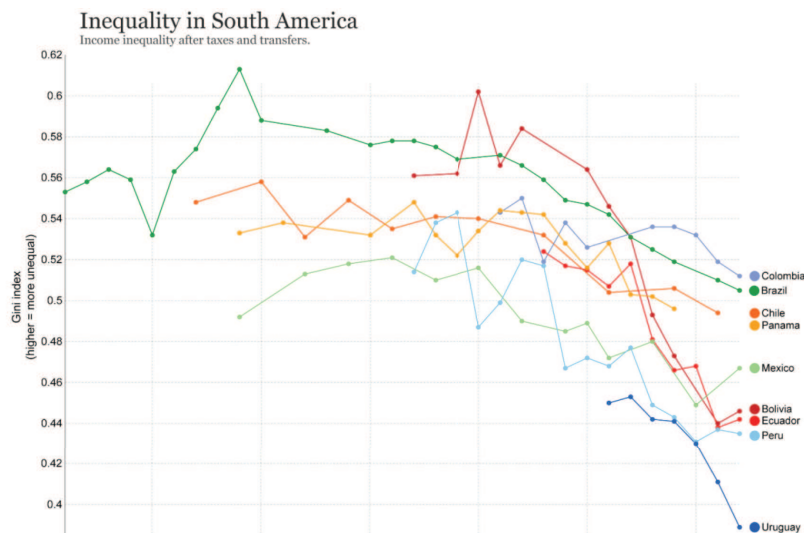
Share of Total Income going to the Top 1%, 1900-2010



Data Source: *Wid.World: The Source for Global Inequality Data (2018)*
 Source: *Roser & Ortiz-Ospina (2018)*

This also appears to apply to some “sensitive” regions, such as Latin America, where in the last decades inequality seems to decline significantly, overall and in most cases. (See Figure 12)

Figure 12



Data Source: *The World Bank: IBRD – IDA (2018)*
 Source: *Roser & Ortiz-Ospina (2018)*

Civitas Gentium 6:1 (2018)

Based on the above data, therefore, there isn’t any sudden explosion of inequalities, on a global scale.

► How to tackle the problem of extreme inequality at its root?

Capitalism has proven that, under certain conditions, might not only fight against the extreme poverty but also to limit the extreme inequality. To limit extreme inequality, but not to eliminate any form of inequality (Rosenberg & Birdzell, 1987).

At this point emerges a need for a new institutional background (Acemoglu, Johnson, & Robinson, 2001; Acemoglu, Johnson, & Robinson, 2005; Acemoglu & Robinson, 2009; Acemoglu & Robinson, 2013; Albert, 1991; Amable, 2005; Berger & Dore, 1996; Corei, 1995; Crouch, 2005; North & Wallis, 2009; O’Brien, 1998; Williamson, 2000), for the necessary structural changes and for the multi-level innovations (Aghion, Akcigit, Bergeaud, Blundell, & Hémous, 2015; Amable & Barre, 1997; Boyer & Didier, 1998; Cohen & Levinthal, 1989; Rosenberg K. L., 1986; Shapiro & Varian, 1999; Soete, 1979; Van Cayseele, 1998), which are the prerequisites for any development attempt of a less developed socio-economic system to squeeze effectively the extreme inequality within. At this point lies the most critical crossroads of inequality that will concern us, for the decades to come, in our own view. It is of utmost importance to distinguish between inequality of the outcome and inequality of the beginning. Usually, we are concerned only with the resulting inequality and, most importantly, with this kind of inequality which is reflected upon the per capita income index. But this inequality never “falls from the sky”. It always incorporates the unequal starting point: inequality in education and knowledge, inequality in terms of upbringing and hygiene, inequality in terms of institutional capacity to create a productive work and, especially nowadays, in terms of potential for innovative action, on every less-favored socio-economic structure.

2.3. *Real against vs. Economy*

An increasing number of scholars on globalization, nowadays, converge on the discovery that there is a profound problem that perpetuates in the vital organs of contemporary global dynamics. The deregulation of international financial markets (Davies H., 2017; Derthick & Quirk, 1985; Kahn, 1990; Peltzman, 1989; Ramesh & Howlett, 2006) has allowed the development of a huge gap between the influence of capital markets and the extent of their supervision. Accordingly, both nationally and internationally, strong systemic risk areas are created, which the existing supervisory framework cannot cope with,

resulting to excessively volatile and crisis-prone capital flows. As a result, the following “paradox” appears and perpetuates: While there is a relative abundance of capital, when countries are less in need, the funds seem to disappear when they could give help on a difficult situation. In this direction, more and more observers seem to draw the conclusion that the supervisory framework needs to be fundamentally reformed, both nationally and internationally (Rodrik, 2011, pp. 125-126).

But what is actually happening today in this area?

► The Financialization of the modern global economy

A lot of contemporary analysts –they usually belong to the “radical” part of the economists’ community– use increasingly the term “Financialization” of the world economy (Adrian & Shin, 2008; Aglietta, 2008; Eckhard & Dodig & Nina & Budyldina, 2014; Jeanne & Rancière, 2008; Kose, Prasad, Rogoff, & Wei, 2006; Martin, 2002; Orhangazi, 2007; Orhangazi, 2008; Prasad, Terrones, & Kose, 2008; Prasad, Rajan, & Subramanian, 2007). They distinguish, in particular, as the predominant feature of the modern era, the explosive rise in financial capital, which has supposedly penetrated into all areas of economic and social activity and which has started to distort the overall evolution of the global capitalism dynamics (Lapavitsas, 2014).

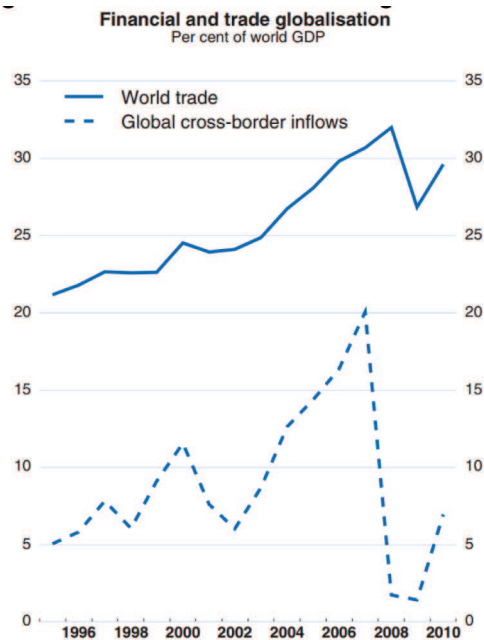
To what extent is it true though that for the first time in the world economic history we face the rapid growth of financial capital?

Deep into the roots of capitalism, centuries ago –even before the complete advent of capitalism, as a state of things which is formed by the necessary and sufficient condition of waged labour– there can be traced the dynamics of financial activities on a global scale (Lenin, 1947). Even more profoundly, by having in mind all the theoretical heritage of the International Political Economy, how someone could still carry on with the “separation” between the financial and the real economy? And, indeed, how could these two spheres be separated? It is not possible.

► Global capital flows and socio-economic development

In 2007, already, the daily volume of international foreign exchange transactions had skyrocketed to 3.2 trillion dollars –multiple times bigger than the volume of international trade which was measured only at 38 billion dollars a day for the same year. The global economy is deluged with financial flows. (See Figure 13)

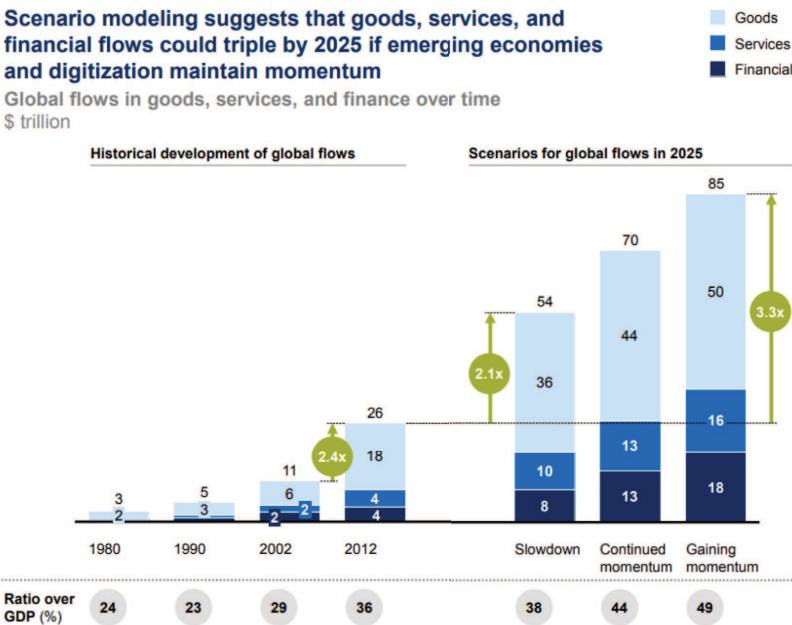
Figure 13



Source: OECD (2011)

And after the dramatic drop in 2007, there seems to be a recovery. (See Figure 14)

Figure 14



Source: McKinsey Global Institute (2014)

Everything suggests that the global flows of goods, services and capital will have tripled by 2025 and with this pace of growth, the global capital flows, according to all the facts known at present, will not cease to dominate.

But is this a good or a bad thing? What are the benefits that the socio-economic systems derive from this deluge of international capital flows? The essential benefits cannot in any case be safely taken for granted.

There is no doubt that a part of this huge volume of international capital flows has just a narrowly speculative and short-lived character; in a “hit and run” logic. In other words, there are “investors”, by definition, aggressive, unstable and volatile. Based on this “investment logic”, it is very difficult for a sustainable socio-economic development on the planet to be established, in the years to come.

► The need to reform the global financial system and the Tobin tax

Not only in the pre-war economy but also in the post-war era, when the “glorious Fordism” flourished (Aglietta, 2008; Boyer, 1986; Boyer, 2002; Boyer & Sallard, 2002; Boyer, 2013), Keynes and his theoretical followers were rejecting the free exchange rate regime. On one hand, they were worried that capital markets would cause excessive volatility in the exchange rates of currencies, because of the successive cycles of euphoria and despair. On the other hand, they were skeptical about the effects of the currencies instability and the uncertainty of the international economy. According to them, there was a clear distinction between the world of employment and production and the world of capital markets. As a result, the free movement of capital was discarded and the controls on the capital flows became fair and acceptable.

Nowadays, of course, we do experience a completely different reality. Not only the currencies fluctuate freely, but also the funds that are constantly moving acquire a significant mobility and power.

As early as 1978, Nobel receiver James Tobin of Yale University seemed to have identified the root of the problem: “The discussions about the exchange rate regime avoid the essential problem,” he noted. The crucial problem for him was clear: the “excessive mobility of private financial capital”. Tobin concluded that the world economy had to choose between two specific paths: The first would be to establish a global currency to replace national currencies. This would eliminate all the difficulties and distortions caused by the exchange rate differences, at the price of course of all countries following a single monetary policy. Considering this scenario politically unlikely, he suggested a second way. In particular, he argued that what it takes is “to throw some sand in the wheels of our excessively efficient international money markets” (Tobin, 1978). To put it in simple

words, he proposed the imposition of a single tax on all international currency exchange transactions, known as the Tobin tax (Aglietta, 2011; Calomiris, 1998; Cohen B. J., 2001; De Grauwe, 2000; De Long, Shleifer, Summers, & Waldmann, 1990; Eichengreen, 1999; Fieleke, 1994; Fischer, 1999; Krugman, 2009; Laurens & Cardoso, 1998; Pilhon, 1996; ul Haq, Kaul, & Grunberg, 1996).

► Mechanisms to “slow down” the capital flows. But why?

And, of course, Tobin was not the only one to support, before his death, a rational “braking” of the global circulation of capital. We, too, support this general orientation (Friedman M. , 1962).

We do think that we should try to apply this braking system on a global scale. Towards a free, global, economy and society and a framework of rules in which there is clarity about the purposes. And to do so with no dogmatism or extremism from either side. Let’s not forget that, among other things, “it does not matter if the cat is black or white, so long as it catches the mice”.

2.4. Economy vs. Society, Nature & Human

Indeed, it is true that the current crisis creates (and continues to create) a lot of agony. A lot of people do argue that maybe throughout the evolution of the modern world economy their social life has been destroyed. That there is a cynical “economy” which destroys every global prospect, both at social, economic and even personal level. At this point, let us examine this view further.

► Economy against Society?

One of the most prominent voices on this problem is the famous French sociologist Alain Touraine, who in a recent book (Touraine, 2014), suggested that: “In the ‘mega- crisis’, which has been manifested in the United States since 2007, the most worrying is its universal character, which explains the destruction of all the institutions that were previously converting the economy into functions of social life controlled by the State ... “. Alain Touraine does not hesitate in his diagnosis; he diagnoses the rupture between the economic activities and social institutions.

What could be the exit, according to Touraine? The two possible exits from the crisis, he says, are first a major disaster, perhaps the European Union will collapse, and, second, a new social life, based not only on the redistribution of national incomes but on the defense of the universal declaration of human rights as the only possible weapon against the apparent triumph of the globalized economy. We have to rebuild every social institution and put them into the service of subjectification and to save the earth rather than to seek for the profit itself”.

► Narrow “Economics” or an ahistorical leap

Clearly, this statement by the prominent sociologist represents not only the “overcoming” of capitalism, the “overcoming” of capitalistic institutions and the “overcoming” of the market role in the economy, but also the “overcoming” of economic reality itself. It is worthwhile to ask: How much value does this argument have?

There has never been, nor will there ever be, a socio-economic system stripped of the inescapable economic basis and its particular economy.

The market is, in fact, nothing more than a “balancing mechanism” of the unsurpassable competitive confrontation, within a world of eternal economic conflict, which derives from the scarcity of resources and goods. In a free economy, the market competition it simply manages to give a sufficient agreement, a mutually accepted balance, at a certain point in time, within some economic activities of a society. In the end, a “rational order” is always enforced by the market: It is, of course, always a relative, historical and evolving rationality and not an ahistorical, absolute, and “universal’ rationality.

In any case, to the extent that the current economic crisis of globalization affects and damages some aspects of our social life –which is what really happens– it does not mean that we can escape from that agony by getting rid of the economic dimension and the necessary economic thinking.

► Environmental limits and sustainable development

At the same time, a lot of voices argue that globalization is responsible for the accelerated destruction of the planet’s natural environment and that we need to better understand the importance of ecological problems, as well as the environmental limits, in the development process (Foster & Clark, 2009; Fotopoulos, 2007).

As ecological problems we define all kinds of disturbances and distortions, which are due to human activity, over the earth’s biosphere and natural environment. To the degree that the ecological problems threaten the survival of an animal or a plant population, they lead to an ecological crisis.

It is, of course, true that the struggle of man, in terms of economy, seems to be without any limits: Every growing (and sometimes irreversible) environmental problem on a local, national and / or planetary scale often indicates this reality. Of course, a supposed “return to the noble life of the wilds” bears an extreme “environmentalism” and lacks a basis to rightly approach the facts. In particular, what becomes more and more important is not “how much” to produce and consume but rather “how and what” to produce (Borowy, 2013).

In effect, when this problem is considered there emerges the discipline of

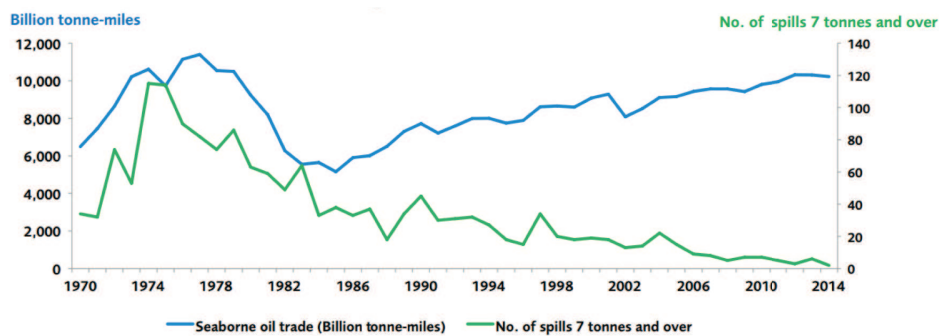
sustainable development (Arrow, et al., 1995; Cyril & Arnaud, 2003; Beckerman, 1995; Boisvert, 2005; Ciriacy-Wantrup, 1952; Comélieau, 1994; Dupuy, 1990; Dupuy, 2004; Grossman & Krueger, 1994), which refers to the particular type of developmental dynamics which, on one hand, allow the ongoing generation to satisfy their needs without, on the other hand, undermining the prospects of the future generations (Βλάχος, 2006).

► Does globalization destroy the global natural environment?

We all, namely the international community, ought to realize that in order for the modern industrial world to build a sustainable environmental balance, there are required, as much by global policy institutions as by entrepreneurs, quickly applicable decisions. And, of course, any efficient environmental regulation requires a lot more than the marketing adjustments. This field of policy requires more than a narrow nation-state intervention in order to be effective. It is reasonable to expect worldwide interventions and regulatory policies when dealing with worldwide problems. There is a distinct challenge lying ahead of us: How to establish, on a global scale, a new model of sustainable development, both in terms of producing and consuming. By focusing not only on quantities but on sufficient quality, on information and knowledge rather than on growing in an energy intensity size.

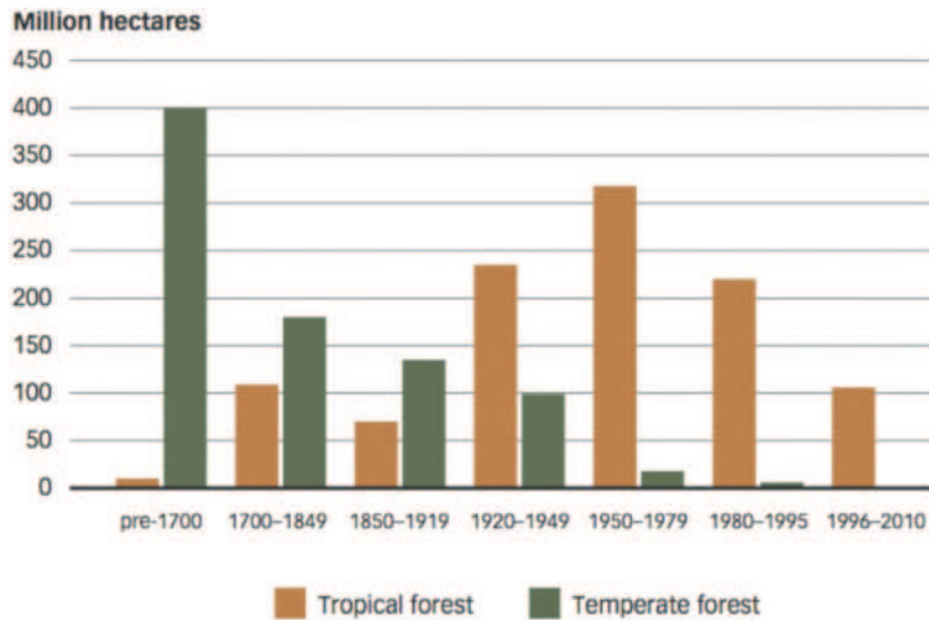
Despite it is a difficult task to form a clear view of the global environmental changes, there are quite a few indicators which demonstrate a relative improvement on several areas, over the recent years. (See Figures 15 & 16)

Figure 15



Source: The International Tanker Owners Pollution Federation Limited (ITOPF) (2018)

Figure 16



Source: Roser (2017)

Overall, based on the available data, although there have been made clear improvements over the recent years, we still haven't found complete answers to the global ecological problems. Compared to yesterday's popular perspective, the current crisis of globalization re-establishes the priorities of the global environmental problem, by examining it on a long-term perspective.

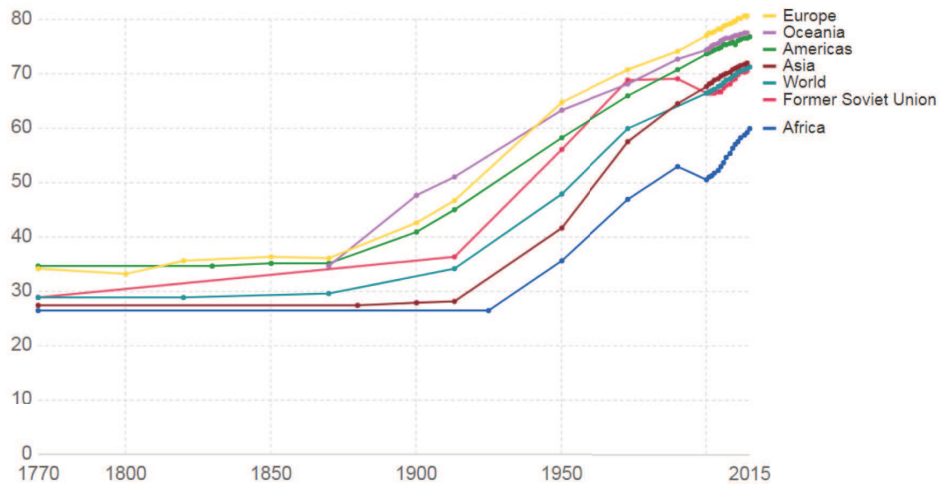
► The social accomplishments of globalization

Beyond the environmental perspective, globalization appears to have significantly elevated humanity to seek even more happiness and personal fulfillment over the recent decades.

First, the longevity of people has expanded as well as the hygiene and overall health which have seen an incredible rise. (See Figure 17)

Figure 17

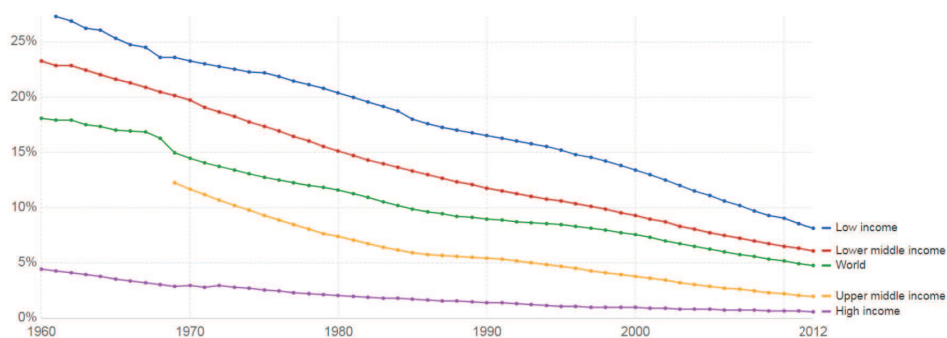
Life expectancy globally and by world regions since 1770



Data Source: Riley (2005); Our World In Data (2016)
Source: Roser (2017)

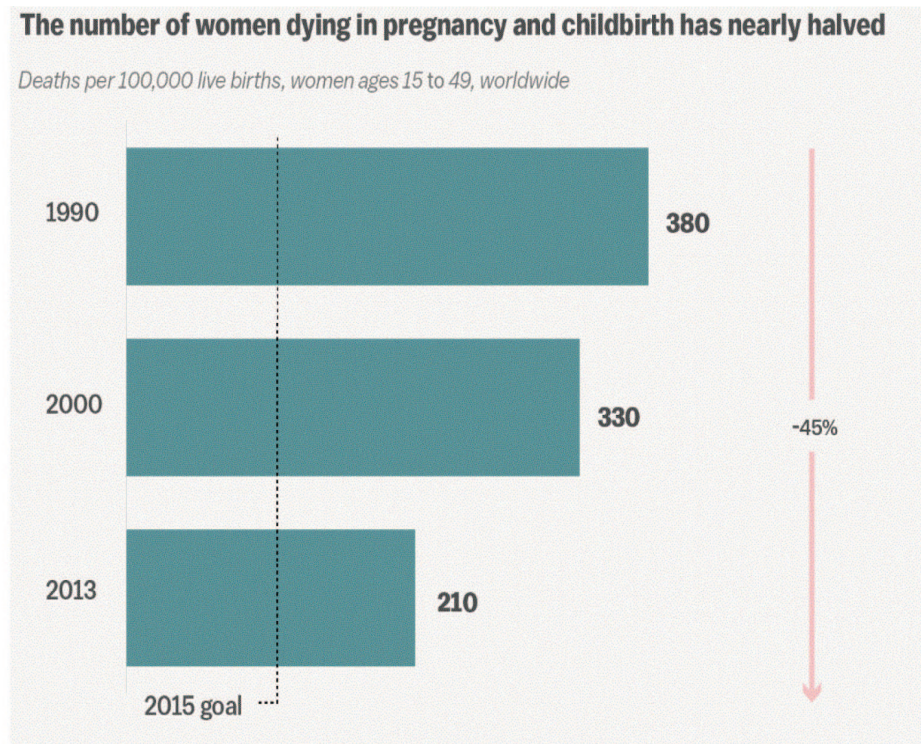
Every person, on average, across the globe, lives significantly longer compared to the past. Each single decade offers additional years of life. Concerning child mortality as well the number of women dying in pregnancy the recent data are, at least, extraordinary, across every region and level of income. (See Figures 18 & 19)

Figure 18



Source: Roser (2018)

Figure 19

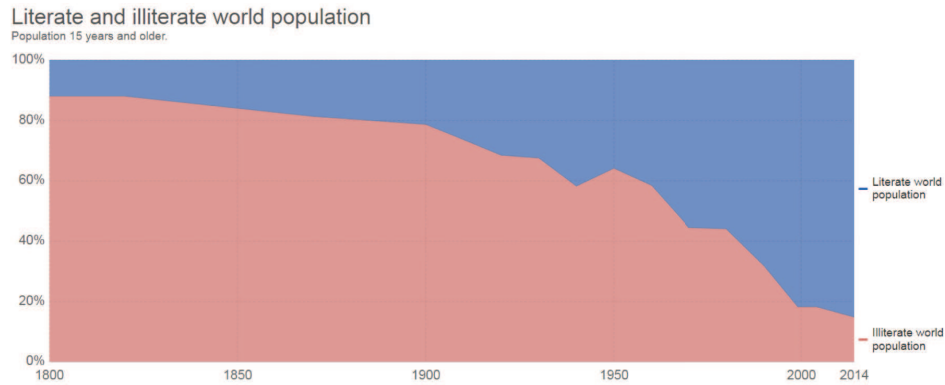


Source: United Nations (2015); World Health Organization, et al. (2015)

At the same time, on the battlefield of education and specialization, the overall battle of humanity against ignorance is more than noticeable. Nowadays, in the vast majority of the world's nations the pre-tertiary education is not only considered a fundamental human right but an obligation undertaken by the government, which have to ensure that every citizen has access to.

In particular, over the second half of the 20th century, the idea that education constitutes a basic human right did expand throughout the globe. This global expansion in the twentieth century, gave rise to a that novel retreat of education inequality that the world has never seen before. Over the 1960-2010 period, in particular, the education inequality was keep falling on an annual base, throughout all age groups and geographic regions of the world (See Figure 20).

Figure 20

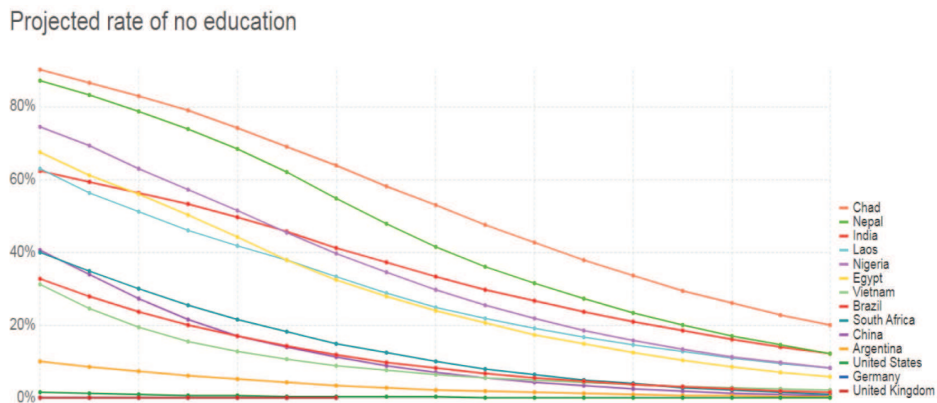


Data Source: van Zanden & et al. (eds) (2014); UNESCO (2018)

Source: Roser & Ortiz-Ospina (2018)

The illiterate part of the world’s population is radically declining, especially since the 1980s, whilst the projections are up and coming for the next years, for the entire world. (See Figure 21)

Figure 21



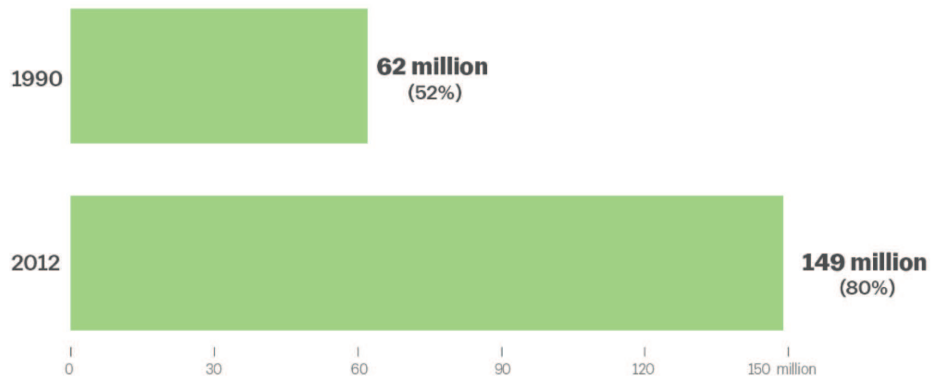
Data Source: Lutz, Butz, & KC (2017)

Source: Roser & Nagdy (2018)

As well, satisfactorily enough, relevant data show that there is a drastic improvement of the scores that Sub-Saharan nations –the most difficult cases– record on the field of education. (See Figure 22)

Figure 22

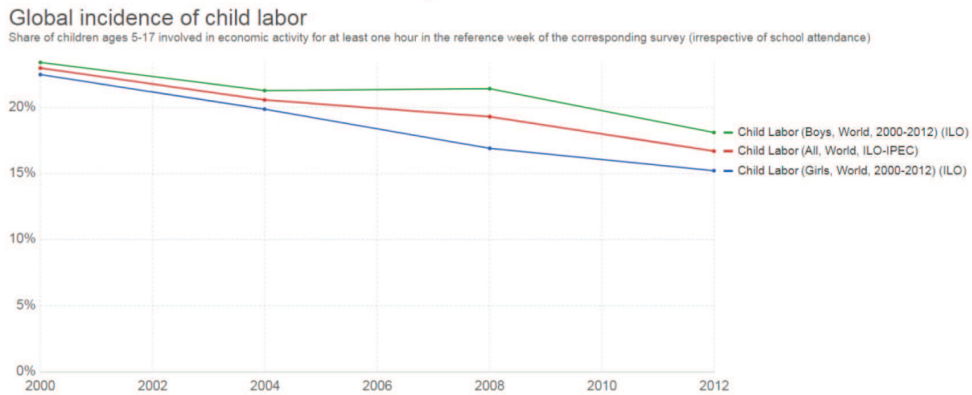
The number of children enrolled in primary school more than doubled in sub-Saharan Africa



Source: United Nations (2015)

Finally, the index of child labor is no less impressive. (See Figure 23)

Figure 23



Data Source: ILO & IPEC (2013)

Source: Roser & Ortiz-Ospina (2018)

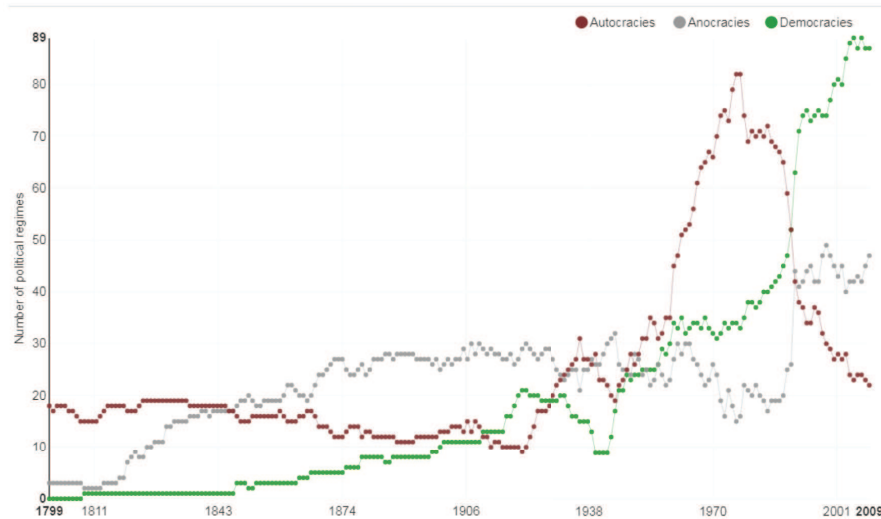
Globally, the incidence of child labor over the recent years is steadily falling.

2.5 Freedom vs. Control

The years of the rise of globalization also seem to show that Democracy has managed to rapidly expand and that authoritarian regimes are limited on the planet. (See Figure 24)

Civitas Gentium 6:1 (2018)

Figure 24: Number of democracies. Between 1800-2010



Data Source: Marshall (dir) (2018)

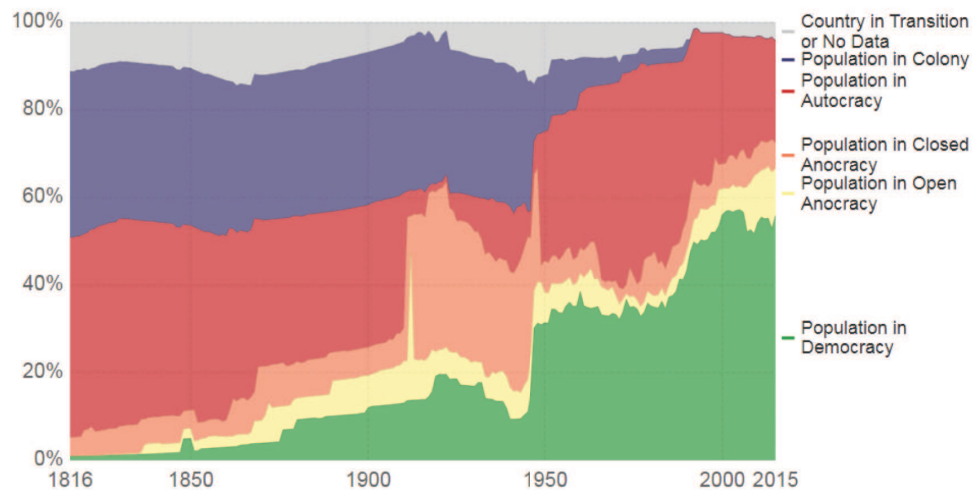
Source: Roser (2018)

More generally, the whole period after the Second World War, appears to be a period of rapid consolidation of Democracy and, at the same time, of a vertical decline of colonialism and authoritarian regimes. (See Figure 25)

Figure 25

Number of world citizens living under different political regimes

The Polity IV score captures the type of political regime for each country on a range from -10 (full autocracy) to +10 (full democracy). Regimes that fall into the middle of this spectrum are called anocracies.



Data Source: Our World In Data (2016)

Source: Roser (2018)

Civitas Gentium 6:1 (2018)

This rapid development led to a largely mistaken analysis by some theorists, such that they rushed to prescribe the “End of History” and the prevalence of the Western ideals throughout the world (Fukuyama, 1992). Of course, about 20 years later, their apparent enthusiasm and galloping optimism do not seem sufficient to explain the modern era. Unfortunately, we are living in a world filled with shades of grey, by the rise of terrorism, to Islamic fundamentalism, and even populism and demagoguery, within the democratic countries of the West. Human history, for sure, will ever be a history of conflicts and ideologies; Freedom will always fight against Control.

► Dani Rodrik and the “trilemma” of Globalization

One of the most important scholars on the world economy nowadays is Dani Rodrik, who raises the question of how to manage the forces between the national democracy and globalization:

“How do we manage the tension between national democracy and global markets? We have three options. We can restrict democracy in the interest of minimizing international transaction costs, disregarding the economic and social whiplash that the global economy occasionally produces. We can limit globalization, in the hope of building democratic legitimacy at home. Or we can globalize democracy, at the cost of national sovereignty. This gives us a menu of options for reconstructing the world economy.” (Rodrik, 2011, pp. 184).

This so-called “trilemma” leads Rodrik to underline the necessity for state intervention. He notes that the countries which managed to grow rich in capitalism are these which have built an extensive network of formal institutions that govern, regulate and control the markets.

We are not in favor of the underlying pessimism in Rodrik’s view, as well as of parallel theoretical approaches that many scholars support. We think that “all three” could be accomplished together: There is not really any “trilemma”, there is simply the challenge for a new global reconstruction. To the extent that we manage to sufficiently articulate the concept of globalization as it unfolds on local, national, and supranational level, then the political intervention would succeed to restructure and increase the efficiency of democracy, on a global scale, and, finally, to bridge the gap between spatial competitiveness with social justice and security.

► Which is finally the role of a modern state on the globalization restructuring?

One significant reason, among others, that the State must intervene to is to avoid distortions of competition, by securing the power of competition rather than acting against. Overall, we think that the authorities should intervene

whenever to correct a false direction of the authentic competition in a free market. The unfair, illegal, and “closed” competition are symptoms deeply negative towards the development of every society.

Therefore, both public and private initiative are required. In particular, a state intervention should be a lot broader, by applying a global perspective on reality and by understanding the structural and long-term effects of regulation, be less-focused on the conjunctural circumstances, on the “election priorities” and political costs, and on the contrary, to be more focus on empowering the potential for innovation, by systematically joining the international efforts and by understanding the inter-dependence between societies (Bosworth & Triplett, 2001; Coriat, Petit, & Schmeder, 2006; Duval, 2003; Esping-Andersen G., 1990; Esping-Andersen G., 1999).

2.6 Uniformity vs. Diversity

A lot of commentators on globalization argue that its development is doing nothing more than destroying and eradicating every possibility of a national (or local) society from maintaining its autonomy, its self-existence and its particular cultural identity (Appadurai, 1996; Mc Luhan & Fiore, 2001; Said, 1993). Some also declare the definitive advent of a “world without borders” (Ohmae, 1991; Ohmae, 1996; Ohmae, 1999).

There is no doubt that globalization actually introduces and promotes, in a first reading, the convergence of different socio-economic systems towards a common capitalistic socio-economic model. In this way, globalization is undoubtedly a homogeneous force, towards a supposedly “American” way of life for all, in the context of modern Western culture.

But how true is this perception? We do not think so and the available data support this observation. Evidence shows that globalization is far from leading to definitive homogenization of different socio-economic systems; it does not, in any way, eliminate every social and cultural dimension and impose ultimately a complete cultural and ideological identity on top of all the world citizens. In fact, it seems that globalization is nothing more than a continuous dynamic and unceasing reproduction of heterogeneity –and, at the same time, it places this diversity on top of even higher levels of differentiation. In essence, it drastically increases the possibility for various local, cultural and even aesthetic peculiarities to emerge, to coexist with others, to perpetuate and to evolve and which, in the absence of its dynamics, would have no opportunity of existence and rescue. In

essence, the dynamics of globalization encompass and activate a never-ending evolutionary hybridism: the co-evolutionary dynamics of uniformity and diversity are constantly restructuring the globalization trajectory.

► The clash of civilizations and the dynamics of Globalization

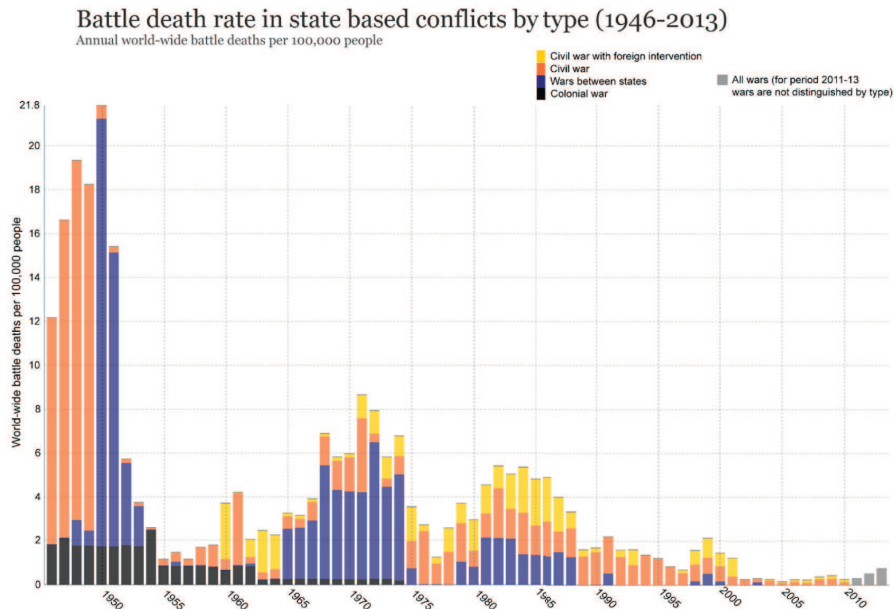
Contemporary contemplation on globalization literature tends to become far more subversive and go beyond the casual limits regarding the revival of classical nationalism (James, 2002). The rapid strengthening of Islamic fundamentalism and the proliferation of international terrorism phenomena, have now redefined the bar of our worries far higher than yesterday.

As many modern scholars have argued, it is no longer narrow nationalism, but something far deeper that directly threatens the dynamics of modern globalization: The Clash of Civilizations (Huntington S., 1996). The clash of civilizations approach, though simple and clear, can only be a victim of its “success”. It is too simplistic to interpret the enormous variety of factors that co-create modern world dynamics.

► Are we really living in an increasingly violent and monolithic world?

At the same time, the available data can hardly support the belief that the dynamics of globalization itself is diverted towards a more and more violent and monolithic world. War victims worldwide have been drastically decreasing since the mid-1980s and after. (See Figure 26)

Figure 26



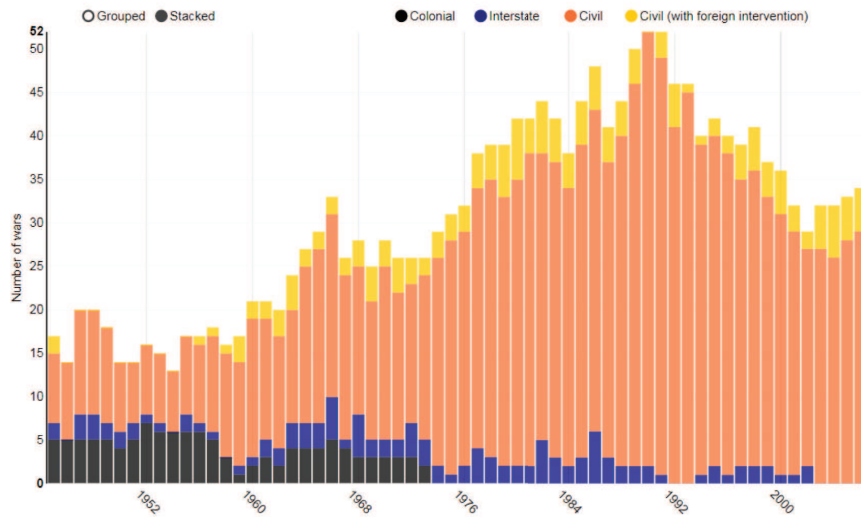
Data Source: Peace Research Institute Oslo (PRIO) (2018); Pinker & Mack (2014)

Source: Roser (2018)

Civitas Gentium 6:1 (2018)

At the same time, the interstate wars tend to be eliminated, mainly passing into the sphere of civil wars. But also at this level there is a decline after 1990 and a relative stabilization in the early years of the 2000s. (See Figure 27)

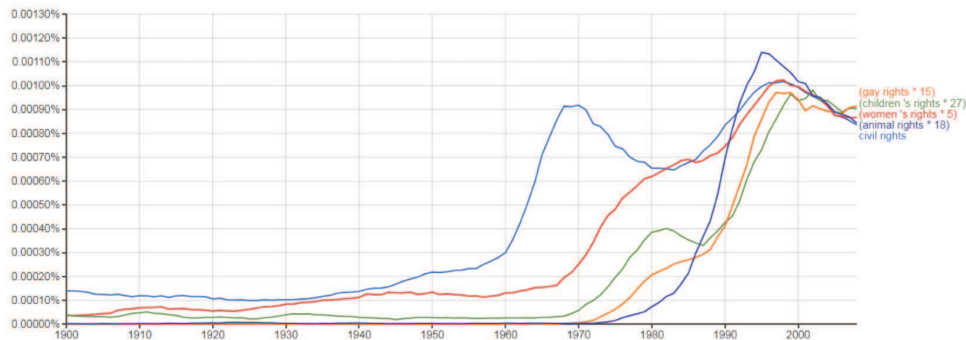
Figure 27 : Number of state-based armed conflicts by type, 1946-2007



Data Source: Peace Research Institute Oslo (PRIO) (2018)
Source: Roser (2018)

The global civil society (Almond & Verba, 1989; Cohen & Arato, 1994; Edwards, 2009; Ehrenberg, 1999; Powell, 2007, pp. 119-120, 148-149; Soper, 2013; Zaleski, 2008), moreover, seems increasingly sensitive to human rights issues and increasingly tolerant to a large number of peculiarities and “divergences”. (See Figure 28)

Figure 28: Use of the phrases ‘civil rights’, ‘women’s rights’, ‘children’s rights’, ‘gay rights’ and ‘animal rights’ in English-language books, 1900-2008 – Google Ngram



Source1: Roser (2017)

1. The source of this graph is Google Ngram. Google has digitalised 5.2 million

Though the situation is clearly improving at this level, overall, it is very difficult for anyone to support that the world of globalization is a world of growing violence, oppression and authoritarianism. This, of course, does not mean that we have reached any “paradise” with respect to this or any other dimension.

3. Concluding remarks: The search for a “New Globalization”

On this article, we examined the achievements of the past phase of globalization, by distinguishing the structural tug of war in the process of a “New Globalization”. To sum up, these evolutionary achievement are the following:

- The absolute poverty has decreased drastically.
- The extreme inequality has significantly reduced, especially to sensitive regions.
- The rapid expansion of “financialization” has made the mass transfer of capital possible to even more less-developed socio-economic systems.
- The environmental awareness and the search for new sustainable development models has entered the global agenda and, at the same time, with respect to human prosperity more and more improvements can be detected (regarding life expectancy, child mortality, illiteracy, hygiene, etc.).
- The institution of parliamentary democracy has expanded, by decreasing the totalitarian regimes.
- The number of war victims has radically decreased throughout the world.

Is this the highest level of development that the world could reach? We do not think so.

Nowadays, the global socio-economic system is on the brink of a new evolutionary era: A phase we name after “New Globalization”. This phase of globalization development represents the definitive overcome of the current crisis and restructuring that we face since 2008. The new developmental dynamics would necessarily be a different structure than the previous, which was prevailing the past 40 years.

Of course, the construction of New Globalization is something full of new and acute challenges. And, undoubtedly, these global “pathogens” have, respectively, demanding “therapies”. (See Figure 29)

books, published between 1500 and 2008, containing 500 billion words (according to Wikipedia). Google Ngram lets you calculate how often a particular word or phrase occurs among all words in all books in any given years and shows these frequencies in a plot.

Figure 29: The directions towards a “New Globalization”



To summarize, the critical structural orientations / reorientations in the effort of building a new development phase of the global socio-economic system, the “New Globalization, comes from the following assumptions:

- The best therapy against poverty, in any socio-economic system, more or less developed, is not a superficial and temporary growth, but a structural socio-economic transformation, which would open the door for a long-term development.
- The best therapy against inequality is not an “exogenous assistance”, but the systemic empowering of equality in terms of development opportunities, for all people, in all societies.
- The best therapy against the excessive financial speculation is to build a new effective regulatory framework, on a global scale.
- The best therapy against narrow “economics” is the understanding that there is no lasting economic success based on a degraded and declining social and environmental background.
- The best therapy for strengthening Human Freedom is the reorganization and restructuring of the role of state intervention, by focusing on increasing the development potential of each society.

- The best therapy for preserving the variety and diversity of our planet is the constant effort to protect tolerance and pluralism.

It becomes increasingly clear that “post-crisis of globalization” world –which struggles to emerge nowadays– requires drastic reorientations and deep structural incisions in order to prevail, in evolutionary terms. All of these, of course, require a vast variety of innovations, at all levels and on a global scale. Diagonally, across every hierarchical level, and in contact with every institution and organism of the world –both private and public, both large and small.

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